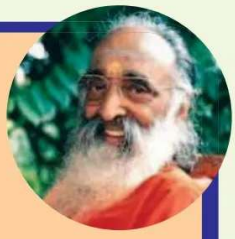
Chapter 8

LIONS OF PUNJAB



"We serve as an army, courageous and disciplined, ever ready to fight against all low tendencies and false values, within and without us. We live honestly the noble life of sacrifice and service, producing more than what we consume and giving more than what we take. We believe that the service of our country is the service of the Lord of Lords, and devotion to the people is devotion to the supreme Self."

- Swami Chinmayananda

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss about Sri Guru Nanak, his life and teachings
- Examine the significant role played by the successors of Guru Nanak and how the gurus in safe-guarded Bharat
- Describe how Guru Gobind Singh and his successors challenged the Mughals
- Illustrate the formation of the Sikh empire under Maharaja Ranjit Singh

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INTRODUCTION

Being geographically located as a gateway to Bharat, Punjab bore the maximum brunt of the invasions. It should be remembered that Punjab which is mentioned here is not the current Indian state of Punjab, but the land situated in current day Pakistan.

It was under these circumstances that Sri Nanak (popularly known as Guru Nanak) was born at Rāi Bhoi Kī Talvandi village (present-day Nankana Sahib, Punjab, Pakistan). This chapter deals with how Sri Guru Nanak through his simple, loving and compassionate ways founded Sikhism. In this lesson we will learn about his successors and how they helped subdue the onslaught of the oppressive religious policies of the Mughals.



Map showing Punjab region

SRI GURU NANAK

Sri Guru Nanak was born on 15 April 1469, in a Hindu Kshatriya family. Nanak's childhood was marked with many events that demonstrated that he was blessed with divine grace. He was married to Sulakhani and had 2 sons, Sri Chand and Laxmi Chand. Guru Nanak later travelled all around the country spreading the message of universal love, service to mankind and social justice, which later developed into Sikhism. Guru Nanak, and his followers emphasized Bhakti (devotion) and described living an active, creative, and practical life of truthfulness, fidelity, self-control and purity.

TEACHINGS OF SRI GURU NANAK

The three guidelines for life professed by Sri Guru Nanak are:

- Vand Shako (share & consume) : Share with others, help those who are in need
- Kirat Karo (work honestly) : Earn an honest living, without exploitation or fraud
- Naam Japo (recite His name) : Recite and meditate on God's name

Sri Guru Nanak called his way as Gurumat or Guru's wisdom. His disciples called themselves Sikhs, which is derived from the Sanskrit word 'shisya' meaning 'the learner'. Sri Guru Nanak or his disciples did not attempt to create a new path or a new religion but were in alignment to Sanatana Dharma. Sri Guru Nanak tried to establish an amity that transcended religion, caste and gender by undertaking journeys called Udasis. In order to bring social inclusivity and equality, Sri Guru Nanak established community kitchens called **Langars**, where food was served to people of all sections of society for free. His message of equality, fraternal love, goodness, and virtue along with the verses of other Sikh Gurus and saints like Kabir, Surdas, Ramdas etc are collectively known as **Guru Granth Sahib**, the holy book of the Sikhs.

EARLY SIKH GURUS

After the death of **Sri Guru Nanak, Guru Angad** became the Guru who began the process of collecting the hymns of Sri Nanak and also contributed about 62 of his own to Guru Granth Sahib. Guru Angad was succeeded by **Guru Amar Das** and **Guru Ram Das**. Guru Ram Das created the city of Amritsar, popularised it by inviting artisans and merchants to settle there and commenced the building of a gurudwara called Harmandir Sahib. **Guru Arjan Dev** completed the construction of Harmandir Sahib (Golden temple).



Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple), Amritsar

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Guru Nanak 1st Guru | Guru Angad 2nd Guru | Guru Amar Das 3rd Guru | Guru Ram Das 4th Guru | Guru Arjan Dev 5th Guru



Guru Hargobind 6th Guru | Guru Har Rai 7th Guru | Guru Har Krishan 8th Guru | Guru Tegh Bahadur 9th Guru | Guru Gobind Singh 10th Guru

MILITARIZING AND POLITICALLY ORGANIZING THE SIKHS

THE MARTYRDOM OF GURU ARJAN DEV

Delhi, Punjab and much of northern Bharat was under the Mughal king Jahangir. Jahangir's son Kusrau rebelled against his father, for which he sought the blessings of Guru Arjan Dev. Jahangir captured the Guru and executed him on 30 May 1606 as the masses were quick to take up Sikhism as their new faith. Guru Arjan Dev was the first martyr* of the Sikh lineage and had a profound impact on the future of the Sikhs.

THE SOLDIER SAINT - GURU HARGOBIND

Arjan Dev's son Hargobind was only 11 years old when he took over. Upon his father's last injunction*, **Guru Hargobind** held two swords by his side, (Miri and Piri, representing spiritual and secular domains). He vowed to militarize the Sikhs to protect the nation and Hindu Dharma, of which Sikhism was a part. He, trained 52 armed body guards, a stable of 700 war horses, 300 horsemen and 60 gunners. He built a steel fort at Amritsar called Lohgarh and administered the place, sitting in a throne like a king, thus marking the political order of the Sikhs.

Between 1621 CE and 1635 CE, Guru Hargobind faced off the Mughals under Shah Jahan in the battles of Rohilla, Sangrana, Lahira and Kartarpur. In all the battles, the Guru himself led the Sikh army, successfully, despite the number of soldiers and resources of the Sikh army being way lower than that of the Mughal army. The Guru ordered his army not to kill the fleeing Mughal soldiers and also offered medical assistance to the wounded Mughal soldiers. After the battle of Lahira, Guru Hargobind cremated the deceased Sikh soldiers with his own hands and built Guru Sar at the site of the battle to commemorate the great victory. With every battle the Sikhs won, Mughal emperor Shah Jahan's treasury was getting emptied.

The Guru was trying to change the age long mentality of Hindus of meekly submitting to the oppressors. After centuries of bondage, he was awakening the masses to a realization that irrespective of the consequence, people should rise against tyranny, bigotry and intolerance. He became a living example to show that spirituality must inspire a person to resist the evil with courage and boldness.

AKAL TAKHT - THE TIMELESS THRONE

In 1609 Guru Hargobind established Akal Takht, opposite to the Harmandir Sahib, connected by a pathway. While the Harmandir Sahib represents Sikh spiritual guidance, the Akal Takht symbolizes the establishment of justice. It was like a combination of a parliament and a court, where the Guru would decide on military strategy and political policy as well as dispense justice. The original structure of Akal Takht was built by Guru Hargobind, Bhai Gurdas and Baba Buddha with their own hands. No other person or artist was employed to build the platform. It was built a fraction lower than the Harmandir Sahib, implying that the search for spiritual grace was always higher.

LATER GURUS

Guru Hargobind also supported the cause of Dara Shikoh, the eldest son of Shah Jahan. He had learnt the Sanskrit language and was inspired by the Upanishadic philosophy, that he had translated into Persian. He was poisoned by his brother Aurangzeb who wanted the throne. Guru Hargobind who passed away in the year 1644, was succeeded by his son **Guru Har Rai**. He popularized the Guru Granth Sahib by public singing and started discourse style recital of the scriptures. Guru Har Rai was succeeded by **Guru Har Kishan**, who died as a 7 year old kid on account of small pox and thereafter **Guru Tegh Bahadur** became the 9th Sikh Guru in the year 1664.

Martyr : A person who sacrifices his/her life for a greater reason
Injunction : Instruction/commandment

GURU TEGH BAHADUR

Tyag Mal joined his father Guru Hargobind in the war against Painde Khan at the Battle of Kartarpur. After the battle was won, the victorious Sikhs honored their hero with a new warrior's name. Tyag Mal was renamed Tegh Bahadur, meaning the brave wielder of sword.

IMPENDING PERIL

In 1658 CE Aurangzeb took over the Mughal Empire. Many Gurudwaras and temples were demolished, Hindus and Sikhs were forcibly converted and brutally killed. Guru Tegh Bahadur came out of his meditative life and set out to travel across many parts of Bharat - Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam and Bengal in 1665. His visits infused confidence and enthusiasm in people when they felt desperate. He gave them spiritual strength and deepened their understanding of the mission to protect our Dharma and culture. During 1674-75, a group of Kashmiri Pandits led by Pandit Kripa Ram Dutt approached the Guru, informing him of the ruthless 'convert or die' scheme by Aurangazeb. The Guru threw a challenge to Aurangzeb to first attempt to convert him to Islam. If he was successful, all others embrace Islam, at least the needless violence could be avoided.



Appeal to Guru Tegh Bahadur

MARTYRDOM OF GURU TEGH BAGHADUR

When Guru Tegh Bahadur was summoned by Aurangazeb he reached Delhi with five of his disciples. When threatened to embrace islam the Guru smilingly replied "I will never, even if my body is cut into a thousand pieces". Despite numerous physical tortures, Guru Tegh Bahadur did not budge. Aurangazeb killed his three disciples, **Bhai Mati Das, Bhai Sati Das** and **Bhai Dayala Das**, in a gruesome way in front of his eyes. Yet, the Guru did not breakdown. The Guru who witnessed the killing of his disciples with unperturbed calmness was then beheaded on 11 November 1675.

THINK!!!

The Guru and his disciples need not have undergone all the torture if he had embraced Islam. Why did they regard their Dharma greater than their lives?

GURU GOBIND SINGH : A GREAT SAGA

After the death of Guru Tegh Bahadur, the responsibility of protecting the Sikhs fell on the shoulders of his son **Gobind Singh**, who became the 10th Guru on 29 March 1676. Brutal execution of his father and great grandfather at the hands of the Mughal kings drove his determination to fight against the tyrannical regime. Gobind Singh had studied the Puranas and knew that Avatars (saviours) are born at crucial times to save the virtuous and re-establish Dharma. He firmly believed this to be his purpose of life. He thus decided to turn the Sikh movement into a political and military regime.



Guru Gobind Singh

THINK!!!

Gobind Singh was born in the year 1666 and became the 10th Guru in the year 1676. He was just a 10 year old boy. What does it take for a 10 year old to lead such a dynamic group of Sikhs and stand up to tyrants?

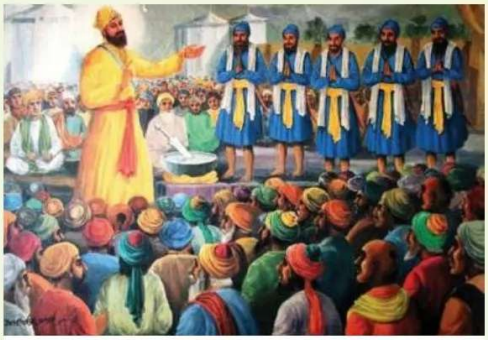
Guru Gobind Singh got educated in reading & writing as well as in martial arts, horse riding etc. In 1684, when he was just 18 years old, he wrote Chandi Di Var, based on Markandeya Purana. Describing the war between the good and the evil where the good stands up against injustice and tyranny.

In 1688 Guru Gobind Singh fought his first major battle, at Bhangani. He was 22 years old then.

When the Mughals lost in the battle at Nandaun, they started fearing Guru Gobind. In fact, it was Guru Gobind's first major battle.

FORMATION OF KHALSA

On 30 March 1699, after deep meditation and contemplation, Guru Gobind delivered the most stirring speech on saving the religion, which was in great peril at the hands of the aggressors. The Guru addressed the large congregation of Sikhs urging them not to look for guardians to protect their Dharmic rights, but to become guardians themselves.



Selection of the Panch Pyare

Guru Gobind roared:

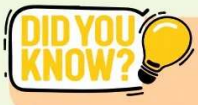
> "What is needed is not just condemnation of evil but also destruction of evil-doers. Love of a neighbor must accompany the punishment of a trespasser. Service of saints implies annihilation of tyrants. Helping friends means harming enemies too. God, Guru and Sword form the trinity in place of Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva. The age of moksha after death has passed. Moksha is to be obtained in this very life, here and now"

Finally, he asked if anyone was ready to offer his head in service of God, truth and religion. This question sent shock waves among the people and no one responded. One man named Dayaram rose up and offered his head. Guru Gobind took Dayaram inside a tent and returned alone to the congregation with his sword drenched in blood. The Guru sought another head and this time a man named Dharam Das rose up and walked to the tent with the Guru. Again Guru Gobind came out with the same bloody sword. Next Himmat Rai, Mohkam Chand, and Sahib Chand followed one afters another. The public was dumbstruck and eager to find out what was running in their Guru's mind. After a short while Guru Gobind returned with the five men who were willing to sacrifice themselves. This was a test to select the best five, for the protection of the good and annihilation of the wicked. The Guru called these five men as beloved ones and called them **Pancha Pyare**. Thus was born the **Khalsa**.

With the creation of Khalsa started a journey of extraordinary valour, breath-taking heroism, fearlessness, unparalleled sufferings and inflexible determination.

RIVER OF WARS

Since the creation of Khalsa, war after war was fought by the Guru for the next 10 years against the Mughals. Significant among them were the battle of Guler (1696), first battle of Anandpur (1700), second battle of Anandpur (1701), battle of Niromgarh (1702), battle of Basoli (1702). In all these battles, the Sikh forces decisively defeated the Mughal army despite the army strength of defending Sikh force was significantly low than the aggressing Mughal army.

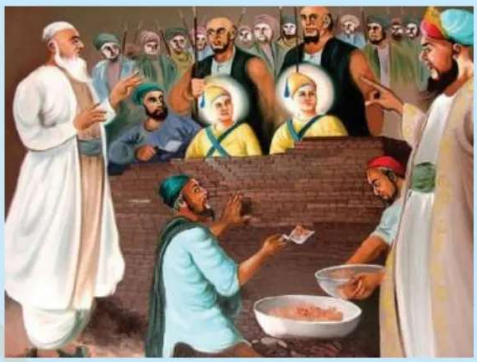


In the first battle of Anandpur, a 1,000 member Sikh army defeated a 10,000 member Mughal Army.

LION CUBS AMIDST THE HYENAS

Once, the Mughal army attacked Guru Gobind Singh his family and followers, when they were travelling from Anandpur to Chamkaur. During this attack, Guru Gobind's mother **Mata Gujri** and two sons, **Zorawar Singh** and **Fateh Singh**, got separated from the larger group and were captured by the Mughals.

The two children, Zorawar Singh aged 9 and Fateh Singh aged 8 were produced before Vazir Khan, the Mughal Governor of Sirhind. He subjected the princes to a trial in his court which lasted for two days. On the first day the princes were cajoled* to embrace Islam and were offered immense riches. The princes rejected the offer and roared thus: "We are the Guru's lions. Why should we fear death? It is best that we should give our lives for the sake of our religion". Vazir Khan declared the two innocent boys to be enemies of the Mughal empire and ordered them to be bricked alive. The two boys, stood calm and composed and were martyred. Upon hearing about the death of her grandchildren, mother of Guru Gobind breathed her last. This event happened on 26 December 1704. Indian Government has declared 26 December as **Veer Bal Diwas** to remember and celebrate the courage and fortitude exhibited by the young princes of the Sikh community.



ZAFARNAMA

In 1705, Guru Gobind was at Dina. When he received a letter from Aurangzeb demanding that should appear in Aurangzeb's court in the Deccan, Guru wrote back a spirited reply to Aurangzeb in Persian language, which is known as Zafarnama, meaning an 'epistle* of victory'. The Guru pricked Aurangazeb's conscience by pointing out how the Mughal army broke the oath taken on their holy book Quran. He recalled how the Mughal army of over 1 lakh soldiers could not succeed in capturing or killing him and that it was a moral victory for him. He warned Aurangzeb of the resolve of the Khalsa to not rest till the evil empire is destroyed. He also showed unflinching faith on the almighty in spite of losing his 4 beloved sons and his mother, along with his many of his fellow Sikh soldiers to the tyranny of Aurangzeb. The Guru rebuked Aurangzeb for his weaknesses as a human being and for the sins he committed as a king.

The Zafarnama is compiled along with Guru Gobind's masterpiece Dasama Granth (a collection of hymns). The Adi Granth was thus completed by the 10th Sikh Guru and it was declared as the guiding force for the Sikhs going forward-Guru Granth Sahib.

One of the popular verses of Zafarnama :

> Chun kar az hameh heelate dar guzasht, Halal ast burdan bi-shamsheer dast
>
> *Meaning : When all has been tried, yet justice is not in sight, it is then right to pick up the sword, it is then right to fight.*

Guru was hoping that he would meet Aurangzeb and would get Vazir Khan punished for his atrocities but received the news of Aurangzeb's death on 3 March 1707.

Cajole : Tempt/flatter **Epistle :** Letter

FINAL DAYS

After a year of journey, Guru reached a monastery of an ascetic named Madho Das Bairagi at Nanded, Maharashatra and decided to spend the rest of his life there, organising the Sikh forces. Guru accepted Madho Das into the Sikh fold and named him as Banda Singh Bahadur and gave him five arrows as a blessing for his future battles. Banda Singh reached Punjab to Punjab to continue the fight against tyranny of Vazir Khan, in August 1708, Vazir Khan hired two boys belonging to Pashtun tribe of Afghanistan to assassinate the Guru. The two secretly followed the Sikh camp, gained access inside the Guru's tent while he was alone and stabbed the Guru fatally. Although Guru was treated for the stab injury, his health deteriorated during October 1708. Realising that his end was nearing, Guru called upon his disciples and gave them the last instructions. He expressed satisfaction at the fulfilment of his mission. He entrusted the responsibility of the Khalsa to the Akal Purkh (God). He asserted that God had destined the Khalsa to be the future rulers of the country and for the realisation of this objective they must continue the struggle unabated. Thus ended a saga of sagacity, sacrifice and valour only to re-emerge in a different name and form.



Distance and Places traveled by the Guru, mapped on current day Google maps

ROAD TO SUPREMACY

MUSCLES OF IRON AND NERVES OF STEEL

Banda Singh Bahadur took over the mantle from Guru Gobind. He waged non-stop war against the Mughals starting from the Battle of Sonipat in the year 1709. Banda conquered the province of Samana (Patiala district of Punjab). He ordered his people to mint coins and brought financial stability. Samana was followed by areas along the Sutluj river. The Battle of Chappar Chiri fought on 12 May 1710 was one of the most important in the Sikh history. The Sikhs defeated the Mughals. Vazir Khan, responsible for the death of the entire family of Guru Gobind Singh was beheaded and the Sikhs established their first Raj (rule) in Punjab. Banda Singh established his capital at Lohgarh at Haryana. With this victory the entire stretch of land between river Sutlej and Delhi laid under the Khalsa, led by Banda Singh. Following this, Banda sent his Sikh army to Uttar Pradesh and brought places like Saharanpur, Jalalabad, Muzaffarnagar under his control. Banda also captured Sadaura in the state of Haryana and killed Nawab Usman Khan, a fanatic who imposed huge Jizya tax on Hindus.


Banda Singh Bahadur

BATTLE OF CHAPPAR CHIRI	
When? 12 May 1710	
Where? Near Sirhind	
Who were the combatants?	
Sikhs	Mughals
Who were the commanders?	
Banda Singh Bahadur	Vazir Khan
Outcome : Revenge extracted for martyrdom of Fateh and Zorawar Singh	
SIGNIFICANCE : Region between Sutlej and Delhi comes under Khalsa	

Banda was not only just a great military general and a conqueror but was also an able administrator. While ruling from Lohgarh, Banda Singh halted the zamindari System and brought an end to the corrupt and inefficient local administration that was prevalent until then. Banda Singh Bahadur met his end in June 1716.

TAKING THE MANTLE FORWARD

Many brave leaders emerged among the Sikhs who have left their mark on Bharat and its culture. Let us briefly understand the contributions of some of them.


Nawab Kapur Singh

NAWAB KAPUR SINGH

He is credited to have brought the Mughals to the negotiation table. By then, the Khalsa had disintegrated, but he reorganized the Khalsa into five groups (Misl). This enabled better governance. Later the five Misls increased to twelve.

JASSA SINGH AHLUWALIA

He formed alliances with other rulers of Bharat, like the Marathas, and mounted effective campaigns against the Durrani* kings. In the battle of Harnaulgarh, he defeated the Afghani forces led by the Durranis.

Delhi captured

In 1783, Sikhs under Jassa Singh and the leaders of two other Misls, namely **Baghel Singh** and **Jassa Singh** Ramgarhia attacked Delhi. They defeated the Mughal army at the Battle of Delhi, pulled down the Mughal flag from the Red Fort and hoisted the Nishan Sahib, the Sikh flag on it. They also detached the throne of Mughal emperor Aurangzeb, on which he ordered the death of Guru Tegh Bahadur, and kept it at the Golden Temple, Amritsar. Even today it is present at the Golden Temple known as Ramgarhia Bunga.

The veteran war leader Jassa Singh spent his last days renovating the city of Amritsar and reforming the Harmandir Sahib gurudwara.

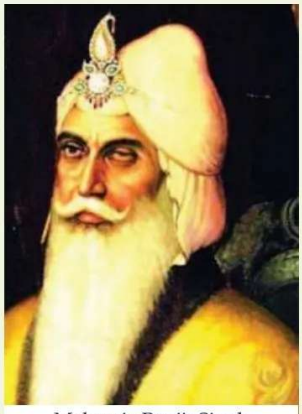

Jassa Singh Ahluwalia

PINNACLE OF GLORY - MAHARAJA RANJIT SINGH

Sukherchakia Misl, one of the 12 misls, was under the control of Maha Singh who died in 1792, leaving the responsibility of leading the Misl to his 12 year old son Ranjit Singh. After the death of Jassa Singh, the 12 Misls developed internal rivalry. However these Misls united in the event of external aggression by the Durranis of Afghanistan.

EARLY CONQUESTS AND PATH TO FAME

In 1797, Durrani king Zaman Shah tried to invade the Sikh territory under Ranjit Singh, who successfully defended the invasion. In 1798, the Afghan ruler sent in another army, which Ranjit Singh did not resist. He let them enter Lahore, then encircled them with his army, blocking off all food and supplies. Ranjit Singh burnt all crops and food sources that could have supported the Afghan army. Much of the Afghan army retreated to Afghanistan. In 1799 Ranjit Singh captured Lahore and Jammu and established his authority among the Sikh misls. He was proclaimed the Maharaja of Punjab in 1801. From thereon it was ceaseless expansion and glory for the next four decades.


Maharaja Ranjit Singh

Durrani : The Pashtun tribe (also known as Abdali) from Afghanistan

EXPANSION OF THE SIKH EMPIRE



Maharaja Ranjit Singh's Empire at its peak, 1839

Soon after becoming the Maharaja, Ranjit Singh paid homage to the holy Harmandir Sahib and vowed to renovate and rebuild it with marble and gold. He then embarked on an expansion spree, ably assisted by his commander **Hari Singh Nalwa**. Ranjit Singh first attacked and annexed Kasur that had been controlled by the Afghans. He then annexed Attock, Multan, Peshawar, Kashmir and other provinces of present day Pakistan and Afghanistan. More than fifteen major battles were waged and won by the Sikh army. In 1837, the Afghans under Dost Muhammad Khan made a final attempt at the battle of Jamrud, to recapture Peshawar. Hari Singh Nalwa led the battle and died a hero. By the end of the battle, the Afghans retreated to Kabul and Sikhs emerged victorious, By this time, the Sikh empire had expanded to the borders of Afghanistan in the north-west to the banks of river Sutlej in the south-east.

Meanwhile, the British had won over the Marathas after the third Anglo Maratha war of 1818. The British were wary of entering Punjab when Ranjit Singh was at the peak of his glory. At the same time, Ranjit Singh also considered it prudent to not engage in a war with the British. Hence the British and Ranjit Singh entered into an agreement through the **Treaty of Amritsar** in 1806. Through this agreement, Sutlej River was marked as the boundary and neither of them would cross the river to intrude into the other's territory.

DID YOU KNOW?

Hari Singh Nalwa ordered that after his death, his dead body was to be positioned outside the fort in view of the Afghan army so that the enemy army would think, Nalwa was still alive and witnessing the war. Mere sight of Nalwa would strike terror in the minds of the Afghan army men.

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SOCIAL CONDITIONS

Ranjit Singh's reign brought peace, order and security to the people living in his kingdom. He built several gurudwaras, temples and even mosques. He ensured that the public living in the conquered territories were not harmed and the places of worship were not damaged or attacked. As promised he laid a golden covering over the Harmandir Sahib. People of all faiths and caste lived in peace under Ranjit Singh's rule.

GOVERNANCE AND REFORMS

People from all religions and races were allowed to serve in Maharaj Ranjit Singh's army including some Europeans. He reorganised the army and equipped it with modern weaponry. He paid the members of the standing army from the treasury, instead of the Mughal method of paying an army out of the levies collected from local feudal chiefs. He also invested heavily on arms and weapons establishing manufacturing facilities for making cannons, gun powder, mining etc. The prosperity of the empire grew merely by improvement in the security situation, reduction in violence, reopened trade routes and greater freedom to conduct commerce.

DID YOU KNOW?

The Kohinoor diamond, went to the hands of the Durranis from the Mughals. After defeating the Durranis, Maharaja Ranjit Singh reclaimed the diamond and offered it to the Jagannatha Temple at Puri.

DID YOU KNOW?

In 1800, Ranjit Singh had installed a huge gate made out of sandalwood, carved with ivory and gold at the Amritsar Harmandir Sahib. This gate was seized from Afghanistan after his victory against them. Many historians believe that this gate was the one looted by Muhammad Ghazni from Somanth temple. After reclaiming the gate, Ranjit Singh offered it back to Somanth, but it could not be used as Somnath itself was in ruins. Ranjit Singh then decided to install the gate at the Harmandir Sahib.

DEATH AND DECLINE

After having established and expanded the Sikh empire to glory, Ranjit Singh died in his sleep on 27 June 1839. The vast and prosperous empire left by Ranjit Singh was not sustained or protected by his successors. His son Kharak Singh was an able and a generous person. However, his council of ministers who corrupt. Poisoned him to death in 1840. After Kharak Singh, the Sikh empire was mired by internal rivalry. The British saw this as an opportune moment to annexe the empire. Two wars called the Anglo-Sikh wars were fought between the British and the disintegrating Sikh empire. Eventually, the Sikhs lost to the British in 1849 and the empire was annexed to British India.

CONCLUSION

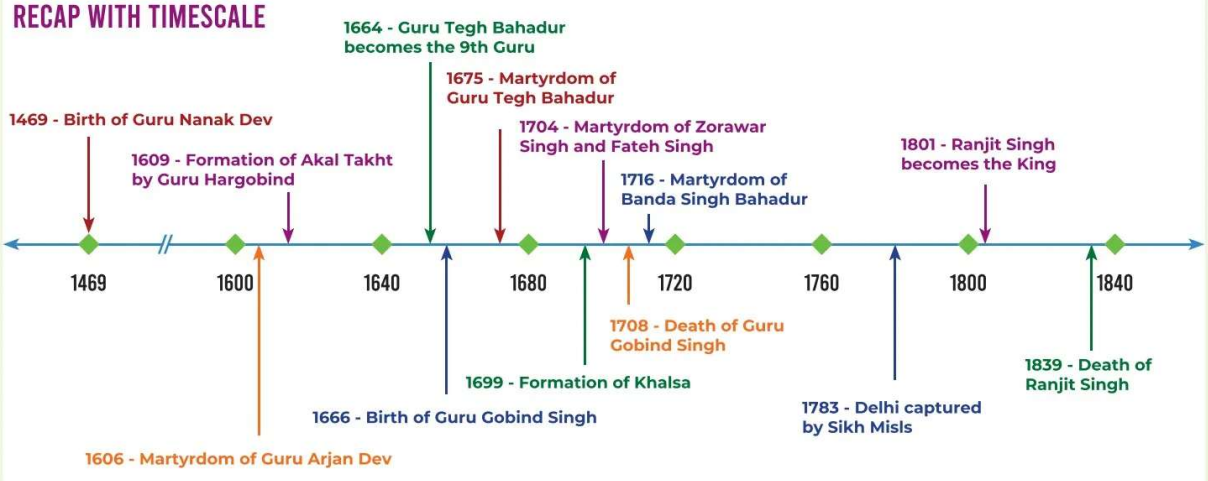
The lives and deeds of the ten Sikh gurus and their followers leave an indelible impression of valour and sacrifice in the pages of history. The philosophical foundation laid by Guru Nanak Dev and steadfast commitment of his successors to the cause of Dharma putting up with the physical torture and loss of lives of the family members make us wonder as to where they derive their strength from. What would have happened to the cultural and civilizational fabric of Bharat, had there been no wall of the Sikh khalsas to withstand the Mughal and the Durrani onslaught of religious persecutions and conversions? This certainly needs to be contemplated.

****

KEYWORDS

- Sri Guru Nanak
- Langar
- Harmandir Sahib
- Amritsar
- Guru Ram Das
- Guru Arjan Dev
- Akal Takht
- Bhai Mati Das
- Soldier Saint
- Guru Gobind Singh
- Khalsa, Martyr
- Veer Bal Diwas
- Fateh & Zorawar Singh
- Delhi captured
- Ranjit Singh

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Sri Nanak was born in Rai Bhoi ki Talvandi village situated in present day _____
   a) Bharat b) Iran c) Pakistan d) Bangladesh
2. The word 'Sikh' is derived from the Sanskrit word 'sishya' that means _____.
   a) the blessed b) the learner c) the dutiful d) the dancer
3. Guru Ram Das created the city of _____.
   a) Jalandhar b) Amritsar c) Patiala d) Ludhiana
4. _____ completed construction of the Harmandir Sahib.
   a) Guru Arjan Dev b) Guru Angad c) Guru Nanak d) Guru Ram Das
5. Guru Hargovind established the _____ opposite to the Harmandir Sahib
   a) Guru Sar b) Akal Takht c) Khalsa d) Langar
6. _____ was the 9th Sikh guru.
   a) Guru Har Rai b) Guru Har Kishan c) Guru Tegh Bahadur d) Guru Hargovind
7. _____, king of the Sikh empire, was responsible for the significant expansion of the empire in the late 18th and early 19th century.
   a) Baghel Singh b) Zorawar Singh c) Gobind Singh d) Ranjit Singh

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. What are the three guidelines for life professed by Sri Guru Nanak?
2. What is the holy book of the Sikhs? Explain.
3. Why was Guru Arjan Dev martyred?
4. Where and why was Guru Sar built?
5. How did Guru Har Rai popularize the Guru Granth Sahib?
6. Who were the Panch Pyare?
7. What were the last instructions of Guru Gobind Singh?

Orange House
Your knowledge Partner

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Explain in detail the reasons for Guru Hargobind to be called a 'soldier saint'.
2. What is Khalsa? How was it formed?
3. When is Veer Bal Diwas celebrated and what does it signify?
4. What is Zafarnama? Explain.
5. Discuss the contributions of Jassa Singh Ahluwalia.
6. Elaborate on the governance and reforms instituted by Maharaja Ranjit Singh.

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

a) Vazir Khan beheaded b) Nawab Kapur Singh reorganizes Khalsa into five groups
c) Formation of Khalsa d) Pandit Kripa Ram Das approaches the Guru
e) Ranjit Singh captures Lahore

CASE STUDY

"Aurangazeb killed his three disciples, Bhai Mati Das, Bhai Sati Das and Bhai Dayala Das, in a gruesome way in front of his eyes. Yet the Guru did not breakdown. The Guru who witnessed the killing of his disciples with unperturbed calmness was then beheaded on 11 November 1675."

1. Who is the Guru we are talking about?
2. Why were the disciples killed?